SkillNavora

HANDBOOK 8

SFMC quick reference

SQL, AMPscript, data views, Journey Builder, Automation Studio, deliverability, APIs and troubleshooting.

Salesforce Marketing Cloud (SFMC) Academy. Verify product names, editions, licences and certifications on Salesforce's official pages.

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Edition: November 2026. Practice labs marked "account" need a provisioned Marketing Cloud account. Other labs use sample files or paper.

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Quick reference

Area	Items
SQL in SFMC	SELECT, FROM, WHERE, GROUP BY, HAVING, ORDER BY, JOIN types, CASE WHEN, COUNT, SUM, AVG, MIN, MAX, ROW_NUMBER. Check the SFMC SQL restrictions before use.
AMPscript functions	VAR, SET, IF/ELSEIF/ELSE/ENDIF, FOR, Lookup, LookupRows, LookupOrderedRows, RowCount, Row, Field, InsertDE, UpdateDE, UpsertDE, DeleteDE, AttributeValue, ProperCase, Concat, Substring, Empty, v().
Data views	_Subscribers, _Sent, _Open, _Click, _Bounce, _Unsubscribe, _Job, _Journey, _JourneyActivity, _SMSMessageTracking, _Complaint, _BusinessUnitUnsubscribes. Keys and retention limits are in the official data view documentation.
Journey Builder	Entry sources (data extension, API event, Salesforce data, audience); activities (email, SMS, push, wait, update contact); splits (decision, engagement, random); exit criteria; re-entry rules.
Automation Studio	SQL Query, Data Extract, File Transfer, Import File, Filter, Script, Verification, send and wait activities; schedule and file-trigger starts.
Deliverability	SPF (authorised senders), DKIM (signature), DMARC (policy and reports), hard and soft bounces, complaints, suppression, sender and domain reputation, inbox placement.
APIs	REST (JSON over HTTP), SOAP (XML with WSDL), OAuth 2.0 client credentials, installed package, access token, bearer header, scopes, rate limits, pagination, webhooks.
Troubleshooting checklist	Confirm impact; check the error and the log; check recent changes; reproduce with a test contact; check data and keys; fix; verify; document the root cause.

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